

Data/MetaData Dictionary Documentation

Introduction

A **Data/MetaData Dictionary** is a centralized repository that defines and describes the structure, content, and meaning of data within a system.

It provides a detailed catalog of tables, fields, data types, constraints, and relationships, enabling teams to understand how data is stored and used.

In Business Central and Azure SQL environments, this document ensures:

- **Data clarity** by defining each field's purpose and format.
- **Consistency** across multiple business units and systems.
- **Improved integration** with other systems like Power Platform, SharePoint, and Azure services.
- **Governance & compliance** by documenting sensitive fields (e.g., PII, financial data).

A well-maintained data dictionary reduces errors, accelerates development, and supports troubleshooting by serving as the **single source of truth** for database definitions.

Diagram Components

The Data/MetaData Dictionary diagram focuses on **individual table and field-level details**. Key components include:

Component	Description
Table Name	Name of the database table (e.g., <code>SalesHeader</code> , <code>Customer</code>).
Field Name	The name of each field within the table.
Data Type	SQL data type for the field (e.g., <code>INT</code> , <code>NVARCHAR(50)</code> , <code>DECIMAL(18,2)</code>).
Nullable / Required	Indicates if the field allows NULL values or must always contain data.

Primary Key (PK)	Unique identifier for each record in the table.
Foreign Key (FK)	Defines a relationship to a field in another table.
Description	Explains the business purpose of the field.
Example Value	A sample value to clarify meaning and expected format.

Modeling Symbol Definitions

Symbol	Representation
Table Box	Represents a single table. Top section shows table name, middle lists fields, bottom may display notes.
Key Icon (🔑)	Denotes Primary Key (PK) field.
Link Arrow	Shows relationships between two tables based on Foreign Keys .
Green Outline	Table or field highlighted for dictionary view, indicating active catalog item.
Italicized Field	Indicates optional field (nullable).

Diagram Example

Below is a **Data/MetaData Dictionary diagram** example using Business Central sample tables (SalesHeader , SalesLine , Customer , Item).

Introduction

Date/MetaData Dictionary is a central repository of information about the data in a database. It contains detailed information or metadata, such as field names, data types, and descriptions of the data elements. Dictionaries are essential for maintaining data consistency and ensuring proper documentation within a database system. They are used by database administrators, developers, and analysts to understand and manage the data structure and its meaning.

Diagram Components

Table Represents a database table

Field Represents an individual column or attribute within a table

Metadata Includes additional information *about* a field, such as description, validation rules, or business meaning

Modeling Symbol Definitions

Table A rectangular box that represents a database table

Field An attribute within a table that may be a key field or a non-key field

Data Type A specification of the kind of data associated with a field

Description A brief textual explanation of a field's purpose or content

Diagram Example

